

Absolutely — **touch** is a very strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “...and that personal **touch** goes a long way.”

Here **touch** means **a small personal quality or gesture that makes something feel warmer, more thoughtful, or more distinctive**. But **touch** also has major meanings involving **physical contact, slight influence/effect, skill/style, communication/contact, emotional impact, and several common fixed expressions**.

Word family: **touch / touched / touching / touchy / touchscreen**

Base word: touch

Verb forms: touch, touches, touched, touching

Related adjectives: touching, touchy

Useful compounds: touchscreen, touch-sensitive

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Meaning in your passage: **touch** = small personal detail that adds warmth or character — 人情味；個人特色；貼心細節

Your sentence:

> “...that personal **touch** goes a long way.”

Here **personal touch** means:

> **a small personal detail, gesture, or way of dealing with people that makes the experience feel warmer, more thoughtful, and less impersonal.**

繁體中文：

讓人感到被重視、較溫暖、有個人特色的細節或做法；人情味、貼心感

Natural translation:

> “That personal touch goes a long way.”

「這種**人情味 / 貼心的個人化細節**真的很有作用。」

So here:

> **personal touch** = 人情味；個人化而貼心的做法

1. **touch = physical contact — 觸碰；接觸**

The core literal noun meaning.

Practice 1

> “The painting was damaged by repeated **touch**.”

「這幅畫因反覆**觸碰**而受損。」

Practice 2

> “The fabric feels soft to the touch.”

「這種布料**摸起來**很柔軟。」

touch = 身體或物件表面彼此接觸的動作 / 感覺

2. **touch = verb, make physical contact — 觸碰；摸**

Practice 3

> “Please do not **touch** the artwork.”

「請不要**觸碰**藝術品。」

Practice 4

> “She touched the frame lightly.”

「她輕輕**碰**了一下**畫框**。」

touch — verb = 身體或物件表面接觸到另一表面

3. **touch = reach/contact slightly — 碰到；接到**

A broader physical verb use.

Practice 5

> “The curtain almost **touches** the floor.”

「窗簾幾乎**碰到**地面。」

Practice 6

> “Their shoulders touched.”

「他們的肩膀**碰在一起**。」

touch = 兩個物體或表面相接或幾乎相接

4. **touch = small amount / hint — 一點；少許；淡淡的**

A major figurative noun sense.

Practice 7

> “Add a **touch** of sugar.”

「加一**點**糖。」

Practice 8

> “The room has a touch of blue.”

「房間帶有一**點藍色**。」

a touch of X = 少量但可以察覺的 X

Very common with:

- * colour
- * flavour
- * humour
- * elegance
- * sadness

5. **touch = small added detail / finishing detail — 點綴；細節**

Closely related to your source use.

Practice 9

> “Flowers added a nice **touch** to the table.”

「花朵為桌面增添了一個很好的**點綴**。」

Practice 10

> “The handwritten note was a thoughtful touch.”

「那張手寫便條是一個很**貼心的細節**。」

touch = 一個小但能改善整體感受 / 外觀的**細節**

This is the same semantic family as **personal touch**.

6. **personal touch** = 人情味；個人化**細節**

Your exact source use.

Practice 11 — Original

> “That **personal touch** goes a long way.”

「這種**人情味 / 個人化的貼心感**很有作用。」

Practice 12

> “Remembering customers’ names adds a personal touch.”

「記得顧客名字會增添一份**人情味**。」

personal touch = 讓服務 / 互動顯得更有溫度、更個人化的小**細節**

7. **touch** = style / distinctive skill — 手法；**風格**

A major art/design/music sense.

Practice 13

> “The painting shows a delicate **touch**.”

「這幅畫展現出細膩的**手法**。」

Practice 14

> “She has a light touch with colour.”

「她用色的**手法**很輕盈細膩。」

touch = 某人在藝術、設計、寫作、音樂等方面的個人處理方式 / 技巧

8. **touch = skill or sensitivity in handling something — 手腕；技巧**

A broader figurative sense.

Practice 15

> “He has a good **touch** with customers.”

「他很懂得與顧客相處，**手腕很好**。」

Practice 16

> “She handled the complaint with a light touch.”

「她用很**巧妙 / 不強硬的方式**處理投訴。」

touch = 處理人或事情時的細膩技巧 / 分寸感

9. **touch = emotional effect / move emotionally — 感動；觸動**

As a verb.

Practice 17

> “The story **touched** me deeply.”

「這個故事深深**感動了我**。」

Practice 18

> “Her kindness touched everyone.”

「她的善意**感動了所有人**。」

****touch — figurative = 令某人產生強烈情感，尤其感動****

10. ****touching = moving / emotionally affecting — 感人的；動人的****

A major related adjective.

Practice 19

> “It was a ****touching**** speech.”

「那是一篇很****感人的演說****。」

Practice 20

> “The reunion was deeply touching.”

「這次重聚非常****感人****。」

****touching = 令人感動、觸動情緒的****

11. ****touch = affect/involve slightly — 影響；涉及****

A useful abstract verb sense.

Practice 21

> “The change ****touched**** every part of the business.”

「這項改變****影響到****生意的每一部分。」

Practice 22

> “The report touches several important issues.”

「報告****涉及****幾個重要議題。」

****touch = 對某人 / 某事產生影響，或提及 / 涉及某主題****

12. ****touch on/upon = 略為提及；涉及****

This is a phrasal construction, so by your rule I'll flag it rather than fully expand.

> **touch on a topic**

> = 略為提到 / 涉及某個主題

Example:

> “The article touches on local business problems.”

「文章略有**提及**本地商業問題。」

13. **touch = contact/communication with someone — 聯絡；接觸**

A major noun sense in fixed expressions.

Practice 23

> “We stayed in **touch** after leaving the office.”

「離職後我們仍然保持**聯絡**。」

Practice 24

> “I lost touch with several old colleagues.”

「我和幾位舊同事**失去了聯絡**。」

touch = 與人保持的聯絡 / 關係

Common expressions:

* keep in touch

* stay in touch

* lose touch

* get in touch

These are idiomatic/fixed, but extremely high-value.

14. **in touch with = 了解；與.....保持聯絡**

Two related uses.

Practice 25

> “She is still **in touch with** her old manager.”

「她仍然和以前的經理**保持聯絡**。」

Practice 26

> “Good businesses stay in touch with what customers want.”

「好的企業會保持**了解顧客需求**。」

in touch with = 與人保持聯絡；或對某情況 / 趨勢保持了解

15. **out of touch = 失去聯絡；不了解現況**

A useful fixed expression.

Practice 27

> “I’ve been **out of touch** with him for years.”

「我和他已經多年**沒有聯絡**。」

Practice 28

> “The company is out of touch with younger customers.”

「這家公司**不了解年輕顧客的需要**。」

out of touch = 與人失去聯絡，或與現況 / 需求脫節

16. **touch = contact in sport / ball contact — 觸球；球感**

A sports sense.

Practice 29

> “That was his first **touch** of the ball.”

「那是他第一次**觸球**。」

Practice 30

> “She has an excellent first touch.”

「她的第一腳**控球 / 觸球技術**很好。」

touch — sport = 球員碰到 / 控制球的動作或技巧

Especially football/soccer.

17. **touch = touchscreen input / tap — 觸控；輕觸**

A major modern technology sense.

Practice 31

> “The screen responds to **touch**.”

「這個螢幕支援**觸控**。」

Practice 32

> “Touch the icon to open the app.”

「**輕觸**圖示開啟應用程式。」

touch — technology = 用手指接觸螢幕以輸入指令

18. **touchscreen = 觸控螢幕**

A major family compound.

Practice 33

> “The machine has a large **touchscreen**.”

「這部機器有一個大型**觸控螢幕**。」

Practice 34

> “Customers place orders on the touchscreen.”

「顧客透過**觸控螢幕**下單。」

****touchscreen = 能以手指 / 觸控方式操作的螢幕****

19. ****touch-sensitive = 觸控感應的；感應觸碰的****

Practice 35

> “The controls are ****touch-sensitive****.”

「這些控制鍵是****觸控感應式的****。」

Practice 36

> “The lamp has a touch-sensitive base.”

「這盞燈的底座具有****觸碰感應功能****。」

****touch-sensitive = 能偵測觸碰並作出反應的****

20. ****touch = slight contact in medicine/physical examination — 觸感；觸診****

A secondary medical/physical sense.

Practice 37

> “The area was painful to the ****touch****.”

「那個位置****一碰就痛****。」

Practice 38

> “The skin felt warm to the touch.”

「皮膚****摸起來很暖****。」

****to the touch = 以觸覺感受到……****

Useful and common.

21. **touchy = easily upset / sensitive — 敏感易怒的；容易被冒犯的**

A useful family extension.

Practice 39

> “He is **touchy** about criticism.”

「他對批評很**敏感 / 容易不高興**。」

Practice 40

> “That is a touchy subject.”

「那是一個**敏感話題**。」

touchy = 容易引起不快，或某人很容易因某事被冒犯

22. **touchy = delicate / requiring care — 棘手的；需要小心處理的**

A related meaning.

Practice 41

> “The negotiation is a **touchy** issue.”

「這場談判是個很**棘手、敏感的問題**。」

Practice 42

> “It’s a touchy situation.”

「這是一個需要**小心處理的敏感情況**。」

touchy = 情況敏感，處理不當容易出問題

Important distinction: **touch vs feel**

You already have **feel** mapped.

touch

= physical contact / act of touching.

feel

= sensation or perception through touch.

> “Touch the fabric.”

= 摸那塊布。

> “Feel how soft it is.”

= 感受一下它有多柔軟。

Important distinction: **touch vs contact**

contact

broader/formal:

physical or communicative connection.

touch

more everyday and can imply direct physical contact or personal connection.

> physical contact

> = 身體接觸

> a gentle touch

> = 輕柔觸碰

Important distinction: **touch vs tap**

touch

= 接觸即可

tap

= 輕輕點一下，通常快速

On a phone:

> touch the screen

> = 觸碰螢幕

> tap the icon

> = 點一下圖示

Important distinction: **touch** vs **press**

You have **press** mapped.

touch

= make contact, often lightly.

press

= apply pressure.

> touch the button

> = 碰一下按鈕

> press the button

> = 按下按鈕

Important distinction: **touch** vs **hit**

touch

= light/contact-only

hit

= forceful impact

> the ball touched the line

> = 球碰到線

> the ball hit the wall

> = 球撞到牆

Important distinction: **touch — physical vs emotional**

Physical:

> “She touched my arm.”

= 她碰了我的手臂。

Emotional:

> “Her words touched me.”

= 她的話感動了我。

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: **touch — contact vs small amount**

Contact:

> “Don’t touch it.”

= 不要碰它。

Small amount:

> “Add a touch of salt.”

= 加一點鹽。

Completely different noun use.

Important distinction: **touch — small amount vs personal detail**

a touch of blue

= 一點藍色

a personal touch

= 人情味 / 個人化細節

Underlying concept:

> a small added element

but different contextual realization.

Important distinction: ****personal touch vs personalization****

****personal touch****

= small human/detail-level warmth.

****personalization****

= systematic adaptation to an individual user/customer.

A bakery remembering a customer's name gives a ****personal touch****.

A website showing customized recommendations is ****personalization****.

Important distinction: ****personal touch vs customer service****

****customer service****

= broader service function/process.

****personal touch****

= the warm, individual human detail that makes service feel less impersonal.

So:

> personal touch is one possible quality of good customer service.

Important distinction: ****touching vs touched****

****touching****

describes the thing causing emotion:

> “It was a touching story.”

= 感人的故事。

touched

describes the person affected:

> “I was touched by the story.”

= 我被故事感動。

Classic -ing / -ed contrast.

Important distinction: **touchy vs touching**

touching

= 感人的

touchy

= 敏感易怒的 / 棘手敏感的

Very different despite similar spelling.

Important distinction: **in touch vs in contact**

in touch

more natural/personal:

> 保持聯絡

in contact

more neutral/formal:

> 保持接觸 / 聯繫

Both can overlap.

Important distinction: ****out of touch — communication vs awareness****

Communication:

> “We lost touch.”

= 我們失去聯絡。

Awareness:

> “The brand is out of touch.”

= 品牌與現實 / 顧客需求脫節。

Same expression, different domain.

Important note on polysemy depth

****Touch**** has a genuinely rich but coherent modern inventory.

The strongest conceptual groups are:

1. ****physical contact****
2. ****small added amount/detail****
3. ****skill/style****
4. ****emotional impact****
5. ****communication/contact****
6. ****technology input****
7. ****sensitivity-related family extension****

We should merge closely related contexts rather than inventing separate senses for every collocation.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

* ****touch — physical contact**** = 觸碰 / 接觸

* ****touch — verb**** = 觸碰 / 摸

* **a touch of** = 一點 / 少許
 * **touch — added detail** = 點綴 / 細節
 * **personal touch** = 人情味 / 個人化貼心感
 * **touch — style/skill** = 手法 / 技巧
 * **touch — emotional effect** = 感動 / 觸動
 * **touching** = 感人的
 * **touch — affect/involve** = 影響 / 涉及
 * **in touch** = 保持聯絡 / 了解
 * **out of touch** = 失去聯絡 / 脫節
 * **touch — sport** = 觸球 / 球感
 * **touch — technology** = 觸控
 * **touchscreen** = 觸控螢幕
 * **touch-sensitive** = 觸控感應的
 * **to the touch** = 摸起來 / 一碰
 * **touchy — person** = 敏感易怒的
 * **touchy — situation/topic** = 敏感 / 棘手的

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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touch — physical noun	身體或物件表面彼此接觸的動作 / 感覺
touch — verb	使身體 / 物件表面接觸另一表面
a touch of X	少量但可以察覺的 X
touch — added detail	小而能改善整體效果 / 感受的細節
personal touch	令服務 / 互動更有人情味、更個人化的小細節
touch — style/skill	某人在藝術、處事等方面的個人手法 / 分寸感
touch — emotional	令某人產生感動或強烈情緒
touching	令人感動、觸動情緒的
touch — affect/involve	影響、涉及某人或某事
in touch	與人保持聯絡；或保持了解某情況
out of touch	與人失去聯絡；或與現況 / 需求脫節
touch — sport	球員碰到或控制球的一次動作 / 技巧
touch — technology	透過手指接觸螢幕輸入指令
touchy — person	對批評 / 某話題很敏感，容易不高興的
touchy — issue	敏感而需要小心處理的

For your original sentence

> “The staff know many customers by name, and that **personal touch** goes a long way.”

The exact meaning is:

personal touch = 店員記得熟客名字這種小小的個人化互動，令顧客感到被重視、有親切感和人

情味。 **

Natural translation:

> **「店員也認得不少熟客的名字，而這種人情味真的很有分量。」 **

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **touch something** → 觸碰某物
- > **a touch of sugar** → 一點糖
- > **a nice touch** → 一個好的點綴 / 細節
- > **personal touch** → 人情味 / 個人化貼心感
- > **touch someone emotionally** → 感動某人
- > **touching story** → 感人的故事
- > **keep in touch** → 保持聯絡
- > **out of touch** → 失聯 / 脫節
- > **touchscreen** → 觸控螢幕
- > **touchy subject** → 敏感話題